

Calisthenics Movement Library

A comprehensive guide to foundational, animal-inspired, and transitional movements in calisthenics.

I. Foundational Static Holds

These moves train body awareness, tension control, and baseline strength. - **Plank**: Start face-down on elbows under shoulders, feet hip-width apart. Brace core, tuck pelvis slightly, keep neck neutral. Avoid sagging or piking hips. - **Hollow Body Hold**: Lie on your back, lower back pressed into floor. Raise head/shoulders and legs, arms overhead, lumbar contact maintained. - **Arch Hold (Superman)**: Lie prone, arms and legs extended. Lift chest/thighs off ground, squeeze glutes, neck neutral.

II. Foundational Dynamic Movements

These build fundamental pushing, pulling, and core strength. - **Push-Up**: Hands under shoulders, elbows ~45°, lower until chest nearly touches floor. - **Pull-Up**: Hang from bar, engage lats, pull chin over bar. - **Bodyweight Squat**: Feet shoulder-width, hips back, squat until thighs parallel or deeper.

III. Animal-Inspired Movements

Functional strength, mobility, and coordination. - **Bear Crawl**: Quadruped position, knees 5 cm off floor, move opposite hand & foot together. - **Crab Walk**: Sit, hands behind hips, lift hips, walk forward/back. - **Frog Jump**: Squat, hands between feet, jump forward landing softly. - **Lizard Crawl**: Low push-up position, knee to elbow as opposite arm reaches forward. - **Duck Walk**: Deep squat walk forward/back. - **Gorilla Walk**: Squat low, hands to floor, hop feet forward outside hands.

IV. Transitional & Flow Movements

Connect exercises into fluid sequences. - **Burpee**: Stand → squat → plank → push-up → jump forward → jump up. - **Mountain Climber**: Plank, alternate knees to chest quickly. - **Beast to Crab Roll**: From bear crawl stance, rotate into crab, reverse back.

V. Example Training Applications

- Strength Circuit: Push-Up → Pull-Up → Pistol Squat → Hollow Hold - Animal Flow Warm-Up: Bear Crawl → Crab Walk → Frog Jump → Lizard Crawl - Core Finisher: Plank → Hollow Rocks → Arch Hold → Mountain Climbers